Board 1
North Deals
None Vul

♠ 6
♥ K Q 8 7 2
♦ K Q
♣ A K 9 6 3

♠ A J 10 4
♥ A 9
♦ 9 8 7 5 3 2
♣ 2

♠ 9 8 5 3 2
♥ 10 5 4 3
♦ J 10
♣ 5 4

♠ K Q 7
♥ J 6
♦ A 6 4
♣ Q J 10 8 7

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♥	Pass	2♣
Pass	4NT[1]	Pass	5♣[2]
All Pass			

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 1 or 4 key cards

5♣ by South
Lead: ♥A

This is the companion to Deal 6. The cards are the same except that the ♦s and ♣s have been swapped.

Again, NORTH has no problem as long as SOUTH holds at least one Key-card. When SOUTH responds 5♣, (showing one Key-card), NORTH can pass.

That's what happens here.

Board 2
South Deals
None Vul

♠ K Q J 8 7 5 2
♥ 4
♦ K 6
♣ A K 5

♠ 4
♥ 9 7 5 2
♦ 9 5 4 3
♣ 8 7 4 2

♠ 10 3
♥ A K 8 6
♦ 10 8 7 2
♣ 10 6 3

♠ A 9 6
♥ Q J 10 3
♦ A Q J
♣ Q J 9

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1NT
Pass	4♣	Pass	4♠
Pass	6♠		
All Pass			

6♠ by South
Lead: ♣4

NORTH needs to know how many Aces SOUTH holds.

One way to find out would be to bid 3♠, (which is forcing), then launch Blackwood.

Another way is to bid 4♣ (Gerber) right now.

The first way is probably better but we needed a Gerber example.

Board 3
North Deals
None Vul

♠ A J 10 5
♥ A K
♦ K 5
♣ A K Q J 4

♠ 9 6
♥ 8 6 4 2
♦ A 10 8 6 2
♣ 10 3

♠ 2
♥ J 10 9 3
♦ Q J 9 7 4 3
♣ 8 5

♠ K Q 8 7 4 3
♥ Q 7 5
♦ —
♣ 9 7 6 2

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	2♣	Pass	2♠
Pass	4NT	Pass	6♦
Pass	7♠		
All Pass			

7♠ by South
Lead: ♦A

SOUTH's positive response shows 8+ points and five or more cards headed by at least two honors.

NORTH figures a small slam would be safe, but just to be sure she uses Blackwood.

SOUTH's 6♦ reply shows one Key-card which must be the trump King, and a ♦ void!.

NORTH readjusts her thinking and decides to bid the Grand.

Board 4
North Deals
Both Vul

	♠ K Q 3 ♥ K 10 9 3 ♦ A 6 ♣ K Q 9 6	
♠ 10 9 5 4 ♥ 6 4 ♦ 5 2 ♣ J 10 5 4 2		♠ J 8 7 2 ♥ J ♦ J 10 9 8 7 4 ♣ A 3
	♠ A 6 ♥ A Q 8 7 5 2 ♦ K Q 3 ♣ 8 7	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1NT	Pass	3♥
Pass	4NT[1]	Pass	5♠[2]
Pass	6♥		
All Pass			

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 2 key cards with the trump queen

6♥ by South
Lead: ♦5

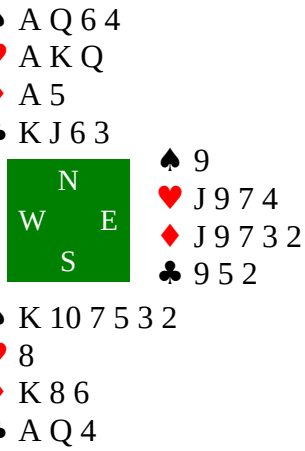
SOUTH jumps in ♥s, showing a good suit and slam interest.

NORTH has great ♥ support so bids RKCB 4NT.

SOUTH responds 5♠, showing two Key Cards and the ♥Q.

That is enough for NORTH to bid the slam.

Board 5
North Deals
None Vul



West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	2♣	Pass	2♠
Pass	3♠	Pass	4NT[1]
Pass	5♦[2]	Pass	5♥
Pass	6♣	Pass	7NT
All Pass			

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 0 or 3 key cards

7NT by South
Lead: ♥6

When NORTH agrees to ♠s, SOUTH will not stop short of a slam. The RKCB 4NT bid tells SOUTH that they have all five Key Cards since NORTH could hardly have a 2♣ opening hand with no Aces.

SOUTH's 5♥ bid is the Queen Ask, and NORTH's reply confirms that she holds the ♠Q, and also has the ♣K.

SOUTH figures the ♠ suit will run, and this should be enough for Grand Slam. He chooses 7NT.

Board 6
North Deals
E-W Vul

	♠ Q 8 6 ♥ Q J 3 ♦ A J 5 ♣ A J 6 5	
♠ J 2 ♥ A K 7 5 4 ♦ 10 8 4 ♣ 10 8 7		♠ 10 9 4 ♥ 10 9 6 2 ♦ 9 6 3 ♣ 9 3 2
	♠ A K 7 5 3 ♥ 8 ♦ K Q 7 2 ♣ K Q 4	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1NT	Pass	3♠
Pass	4♠	Pass	4NT[1]
Pass	5♠[2]	Pass	6♠
All Pass			

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 2 key cards with the trump queen

6♠ by South
Lead: ♥K

SOUTH knows there are enough points for slam, but she is worried about the trump suit. NORTH's support doesn't guarantee more than three ♠s, and if they are not headed by the Queen she could lose a trump trick.

Her RKCB bid relieves her mind when SOUTH claims two Key Cards PLUS the ♠Q. She bids 6♠ (and hopes for a 3-2 trump split!).